

Arms, Military

This document focuses on **Arms and Military** equipment used for offense and defense from ancient times, specifically during the biblical era. The text references various types of weaponry, their uses, and symbolic meanings, primarily drawing from biblical passages.

- **Offensive weapons** mentioned include swords, daggers, darts, javelins, spears, lances, battle-axes, bows, arrows, slings, and handstaffs. These weapons were used to attack and overpower enemies.

- **Defensive weapons** discussed include helmets, coats of mail, breastplates, habergeons, brigandines, girdles, targets, greaves, shields, and bucklers. These were designed to protect the wearer from enemy attacks.

- The document also details **siege weapons** like battering rams and engines for casting stones, used to breach fortifications and cities.

- **The use and maintenance of weapons** are described, including how they were provided (by individuals or public arsenals), how they were prepared for battle (burnished and anointed), and how they were stored.

- **The document concludes by highlighting the symbolic and illustrative meanings of weapons in the Bible.** They are often used to represent spiritual armor, spiritual weapons, and God's judgments.

Overall, the document offers a glimpse into the types of weaponry used in ancient times, their significance in warfare, and their symbolic interpretations in the Bible.

Arms, Military

Made of iron, steel, or brass.

Job 20:24 He shall flee from the iron weapon, and the bow of steel shall strike him through.

1 Samuel 17:5-6 And he had an helmet of brass upon his head, and he was armed with a coat of mail; and the weight of the coat was five thousand shekels of brass. 6 And he had greaves of brass upon his legs, and a target of brass between his shoulders.

OFFENSIVE:

Sword.

Judges 20:15 And the children of Benjamin were numbered at that time out of the cities twenty and six thousand men that drew sword, beside the inhabitants of Gibeah, which were numbered seven hundred Chosen men.

Ezekiel 32:27 And they shall not lie with the mighty that are fallen of the uncircumcised, which are gone down to Hell with their weapons of war: and they have laid their swords under their heads, but their iniquities shall be upon their bones, though they were the terror of the mighty in the land of the living.

Two-edged sword.

Psalms 149:6 Let the high praises of God be in their mouth, and a Twoedged Sword in their hand;

Proverbs 5:4 But her end is bitter as wormwood, sharp as a Twoedged Sword.

Dagger.

Judges 3:16 But Ehud made him a dagger which had two edges, of a cubit length; and he did gird it under his raiment upon his right thigh.

Judges 3:21-22 And Ehud put forth his left hand, and took the dagger from his right thigh, and thrust it into his belly: 22 And the haft also went in after the blade; and the fat closed upon the blade, so that he could not draw the dagger out of his belly; and the dirt came out.

Dart or javelin.

1 Samuel 18:10-11 And it came to pass on the morrow, that the evil spirit from God came upon Saul, and he prophesied in the midst of the house: and David played with his hand, as at other times: and there was a javelin in Saul's hand. 11 And Saul cast the javelin; for he said, I will smite David even to the wall with it. And David avoided out of his presence twice.

2 Samuel 18:14 Then said Joab, I may not tarry thus with thee. And he took three darts in his hand, and thrust them through the heart of Absalom, while he was yet alive in the midst of the oak.

Spear or lance.

1 Samuel 26:7 So David and Abishai came to the people by night: and, behold, Saul lay sleeping within the trench, and his spear stuck in the ground at his Bolster: but Abner and the people lay round about him.

Jeremiah 50:42 They shall hold the bow and the lance: they are cruel, and will not shew mercy: their voice shall roar like the sea, and they shall ride upon Horses, every one put in Array, like a man to the battle, against thee, O daughter of Babylon.

Battle-axe.

Ezekiel 26:9 And he shall set engines of war against thy walls, and with his axes he shall break down thy towers.

Jeremiah 51:20 Thou Art my battle axe and weapons of war: for with thee will I break in pieces the nations, and with thee will I destroy kingdoms;

Bow and arrows.

Genesis 48:22 Moreover I have given to thee one portion above thy Brethren, which I took out of the hand of the Amorite with my sword and with my bow.

1 Kings 22:34 And a certain man drew a bow at a venture, and smote the king of Israel between the joints of the harness: wherefore he said unto the driver of his chariot, Turn thine hand, and carry me out of the host; for I am wounded.

Sling.

1 Samuel 17:50 So David prevailed over the Philistine with a sling and with a stone, and smote the Philistine, and slew him; but there was no sword in the hand of David.

2 Kings 3:25 And they beat down the cities, and on every good piece of land cast every man his stone, and filled it; and they stopped all the wells of water, and felled all the good trees: only in Kirharaseth left they the stones thereof; howbeit the slingers went about it, and smote it.
Handstaff.

Matthew 26:47 And while he yet spake, lo, Judas, one of the twelve, came, and with him a great multitude with swords and staves, from the chief priests and elders of the people.
Called weapons of war.

2 Samuel 1:27 How are the mighty fallen, and the weapons of war perished!
Called instruments of war.

1 Chronicles 12:33 Of Zebulun, such as went forth to battle, expert in war, with all instruments of war, fifty thousand, which could keep rank: they were not of double heart.

1 Chronicles 12:37 And on the other side of Jordan, of the Reubenites, and the Gadites, and of the half tribe of Manasseh, with all manner of instruments of war for the battle, an hundred and twenty thousand.

Called instruments of Death.

Psalm 7:13 He hath also prepared for him the instruments of Death; he ordaineth his arrows against the persecutors.

DEFENSIVE:

Helmet.

1 Samuel 17:5 And he had an helmet of brass upon his head, and he was armed with a coat of mail; and the weight of the coat was five thousand shekels of brass.

1 Samuel 17:38 And Saul armed David with his armour, and he put an helmet of brass upon his head; also he armed him with a coat of mail.

2 Chronicles 26:14 And Uzziah prepared for them throughout all the host shields, and spears,

and helmets, and habergeons, and bows, and slings to cast stones.

Coat of mail, breastplate, habergeon, or Brigandine.

1 Samuel 17:5 And he had an helmet of brass upon his head, and he was armed with a coat of mail; and the weight of the coat was five thousand shekels of brass.

1 Samuel 17:38 And Saul armed David with his armour, and he put an helmet of brass upon his head; also he armed him with a coat of mail.

Girdle.

1 Samuel 18:4 And Jonathan stripped himself of the robe that was upon him, and gave it to David, and his garments, even to his sword, and to his bow, and to his girdle.

2 Samuel 18:11 And Joab said unto the man that told him, And, behold, thou sawest him, and why didst thou not smite him there to the ground? and I would have given thee ten shekels of silver, and a girdle.

Target.

1 Samuel 17:6 And he had greaves of brass upon his legs, and a target of brass between his shoulders.

Greaves.

1 Samuel 17:6 And he had greaves of brass upon his legs, and a target of brass between his shoulders.

Shield.

1 Kings 10:16 And king Solomon made two hundred targets of beaten gold: six hundred shekels of gold went to one target.

1 Kings 14:26-27 And he took away the treasures of the house of the LORD, and the treasures of the king's house; he even took away all: and he took away all the shields of gold which Solomon had made. 27 And king Rehoboam made in their stead brasen shields, and committed them unto the hands of the chief of the guard, which kept the door of the king's house.

Buckler.

1 Chronicles 5:18 The sons of Reuben, and the Gadites, and half the tribe of Manasseh, of valiant men, men able to bear Buckler and sword, and to shoot with bow, and skilful in war, were four and forty thousand seven hundred and threescore, that went out to the war.

Ezekiel 26:8 He shall slay with the sword thy daughters in the field: and he shall make a fort against thee, and cast a mount against thee, and lift up the Buckler against thee.

Called harness.

1 Kings 22:34 And a certain man drew a bow at a venture, and smote the king of Israel between the joints of the harness: wherefore he said unto the driver of his chariot, Turn thine hand, and carry me out of the host; for I am wounded.

Called armor.

Luke 11:22 But when a stronger than he shall come upon him, and overcome him, he taketh from him all his armour wherein he trusted, and divideth his spoils.

FOR SIEGES:

Battering Rams.

2 Samuel 20:15 And they came and besieged him in Abel of Bethmaachah, and they cast up a bank against the city, and it stood in the trench: and all the people that were with Joab battered the wall, to throw it down.

Ezekiel 4:2 And lay siege against it, and build a fort against it, and cast a mount against it; set the camp also against it, and set battering rams against it round about.

Engines for casting stones, ect.

2 Chronicles 26:15 And he made in Jerusalem engines, invented by cunning men, to be on the towers and upon the Bulwarks, to shoot arrows and great stones withal. And his name spread far abroad; for he was marvellously helped, till he was strong.

Not worn in ordinary times.

1 Samuel 21:8 And David said unto Ahimelech, And is there not here under thine hand spear or sword? for I have neither brought my sword nor my weapons with me, because the king's

business required haste.

Put on at the first alarm.

Isaiah 8:9 Associate yourselves, O ye people, and ye shall be broken in pieces; and give ear, all ye of far countries: gird yourselves, and ye shall be broken in pieces; gird yourselves, and ye shall be broken in pieces.

Jeremiah 46:3-4 Order ye the Buckler and shield, and draw near to battle. 4 Harness the Horses; and get up, ye horsemen, and stand forth with your helmets; furbish the spears, and put on the brigandines.

Armories built for.

2 Kings 20:13 And Hezekiah hearkened unto them, and shewed them all the house of his precious things, the silver, and the gold, and the spices, and the precious ointment, and all the house of his armour, and all that was found in his treasures: there was nothing in his house, nor in all his dominion, that Hezekiah shewed them not.

Song of Solomon 4:4 Thy neck is like the tower of David builded for an armoury, whereon there hang a thousand bucklers, all shields of mighty men.

Great stores of, prepared.

2 Chronicles 32:5 Also he strengthened himself, and built up all the wall that was broken, and raised it up to the towers, and another wall without, and repaired Millo in the city of David, and made darts and shields in Abundance.

WERE PROVIDED

By individuals themselves.

1 Chronicles 12:33 Of Zebulun, such as went forth to battle, expert in war, with all instruments of war, fifty thousand, which could keep rank: they were not of double heart.

1 Chronicles 12:37 And on the other side of Jordan, of the Reubenites, and the Gadites, and of the half tribe of Manasseh, with all manner of instruments of war for the battle, an hundred and twenty thousand.

From the public arsenals.

2 Chronicles 11:12 And in every several city he put shields and spears, and made them exceeding strong, having Judah and Benjamin on his side.

2 Chronicles 26:14 And Uzziah prepared for them throughout all the host shields, and spears, and helmets, and habergeons, and bows, and slings to cast stones.

Often given as presents.

1 Kings 10:25 And they brought every man his present, vessels of silver, and vessels of gold, and garments, and armour, and spices, Horses, and Mules, a rate year by year.

BEFORE USING

Tried and proved.

1 Samuel 17:39 And David girded his sword upon his armour, and he Assayed to go; for he had not proved it. And David said unto Saul, I cannot go with these; for I have not proved them.

And David put them off him.

Burnished.

Jeremiah 46:4 Harness the Horses; and get up, ye horsemen, and stand forth with your helmets; furbish the spears, and put on the brigandines.

Ezekiel 21:9-11 Son of man, prophesy, and say, Thus saith the LORD; Say, A sword, a sword is sharpened, and also furbished: 10 It is sharpened to make a sore slaughter; it is furbished that it may glitter: should we then make mirth? it contemneth the rod of my son, as every tree. 11 And he hath given it to be furbished, that it may be handled: this sword is sharpened, and it is furbished, to give it into the hand of the slayer.

Ezekiel 21:28 And thou, son of man, prophesy and say, Thus saith the Lord GOD concerning the Ammonites, and concerning their reproach; even say thou, The sword, the sword is drawn: for the slaughter it is furbished, to consume because of the glittering:

Anointed.

Isaiah 21:5 Prepare the table, watch in the watchtower, eat, drink: arise, ye Princes, and anoint

the shield.

Part of, borne by armor-bearers.

Judges 9:54 Then he called hastily unto the young man his armourbearer, and said unto him, Draw thy sword, and slay me, that men say not of me, A woman slew him. And his young man thrust him through, and he died.

1 Samuel 14:1 Now it came to pass upon a day, that Jonathan the son of Saul said unto the young man that bare his armour, Come, and let us go over to the Philistines' garrison, that is on the other side. But he told not his Father.

1 Samuel 16:21 And David came to Saul, and stood before him: and he loved him greatly; and he became his armourbearer.

Hung of the walls of cities.

Ezekiel 27:10-11 They of Persia and of Lud and of Phut were in thine army, thy men of war: they hanged the shield and helmet in thee; they set forth thy comeliness. 11 The men of Arvad with thine army were upon thy walls round about, and the Gammadims were in thy towers: they hanged their shields upon thy walls round about; they have made thy beauty perfect.

OF THE VANQUISHED,

Taken off them.

2 Samuel 2:21 And Abner said to him, Turn thee aside to thy right hand or to thy left, and lay thee hold on one of the young men, and take thee his armour. But Asahel would not turn aside from following of him.

Luke 11:22 But when a stronger than he shall come upon him, and overcome him, he taketh from him all his armour wherein he trusted, and divideth his spoils.

Sometimes kept as trophies.

1 Samuel 17:54 And David took the head of the Philistine, and brought it to Jerusalem; but he put his armour in his tent.

Sometime burned.

Ezekiel 39:9-10 And they that dwell in the cities of Israel shall go forth, and shall set on fire and burn the weapons, both the shields and the bucklers, the bows and the arrows, and the handstaves, and the spears, and they shall burn them with fire seven years: 10 So that they shall take no wood out of the field, neither cut down any out of the forests; for they shall burn the weapons with fire: and they shall spoil those that spoiled them, and rob those that robbed them, saith the Lord GOD.

Of conquered nations taken away to prevent rebellion.

Judges 5:8 They chose new gods; then was war in the gates: was there a shield or spear seen among forty thousand in Israel?

1 Samuel 13:19-22 Now there was no smith found throughout all the land of Israel: for the Philistines said, Lest the Hebrews make them swords or spears: 20 But all the Israelites went down to the Philistines, to sharpen every man his share, and his Coulter, and his axe, and his mattock. 21 Yet they had a file for the mattocks, and for the coulter, and for the forks, and for the axes, and to sharpen the goads. 22 So it came to pass in the day of battle, that there was neither sword nor spear found in the hand of any of the people that were with Saul and Jonathan: but with Saul and with Jonathan his son was there found.

Inferior to wisdom.

Ecclesiastes 9:18 Wisdom is better than weapons of war: but one sinner destroyeth much good.

ILLUSTRATIVE OF

Spiritual armor.

Romans 13:12 The night is far spent, the day is at hand: let us therefore cast off the works of darkness, and let us put on the armour of Light.

2 Corinthians 6:7 By the word of truth, by the power of God, by the armour of righteousness on the right hand and on the left,

Ephesians 6:11-14 Put on the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to stand against the wiles of the devil. 12 For we wrestle not against flesh and blood, but against principalities,

against powers, against the rulers of the darkness of this world, against spiritual wickedness in high places. 13 Wherefore take unto you the whole armour of God, that ye may be able to withstand in the evil day, and having done all, to stand. 14 Stand therefore, having your loins girt about with truth, and having on the breastplate of righteousness;

1 Thessalonians 5:8 But let us, who are of the day, be sober, putting on the breastplate of Faith and love; and for an helmet, the hope of Salvation.

Spiritual weapons.

2 Corinthians 10:4 (For the weapons of our warfare are not Carnal, but mighty through God to the pulling down of strong holds;)

Ephesians 6:17 And take the helmet of Salvation, and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God:

Judgments of God.

Isaiah 13:5 They come from a far country, from the end of heaven, even the LORD, and the weapons of his indignation, to destroy the whole land.

Jeremiah 50:25 The LORD hath opened his armoury, and hath brought forth the weapons of his indignation: for this is the work of the Lord GOD of hosts in the land of the Chaldeans.